Force's recommendations, streamline procurement and troubleshoot problems which cropped up in real-time basis. In the event the groups were unable to find a solution or there was a hold-up, the matter would be immediately raised for the attention of the two advisors to the prime minister. If solution of the matter was not found even then, it would be further put to the attention of Dr Mishra, who would then either find a solution or, depending on the scale of the matter, bring it to the prime minister's notice for guidance.

The broader areas of the 11 empowered groups were:

1. Setting up a medical emergency management plan;
2. Ensuring the availability of hospitals, isolation and quarantine facilities, disease surveillance measures and testing and critical-care training;
3. Ensuring the availability of essential medical equipment such as PPE kits, masks, gloves and ventilators as well as looking into their production, procurement, import and distribution;
4. Augmenting human resources and capacity building;
5. Facilitating supply chain and logistics management for the availability of necessary items such as food and medicines;
6. Coordinating with the private sector, NGOs and international organizations for response-related activities;
7. Taking up economic and welfare measures;
8. Introducing information, communication and public awareness measures;
9. Augmenting technology and data management;
10. Responding to public grievances and suggestions;
11. Considering strategic issues relating to lockdown.

As more travel restrictions were imposed across the world, several Indians living in various countries expressed their desire to return to India. Similarly, several foreigners in India also wanted to return to their home countries. This task would require coordination between governments and embassies of each country from which we would either need to bring back our citizens or send the foreigners to. Even within our government infrastructure, inter-ministerial coordination would be required to arrange for flights, visas, health status checks and so on. For this purpose, the Ministry of External Affairs set up a COVID-19 Cell, which would oversee